Pip and the Moon

A bedtime story

In a little town at the edge of a big green forest lived a hedgehog named Pip. Pip had a red scarf, a round nose, and one very big wish: he wanted to see the moon up close.

Every night, Pip climbed the tallest hill and stretched up on his tiptoes. "Just a little closer," he whispered. But the moon always stayed far, far away, glowing like a silver button in the sky.

One evening, a sleepy owl named Olive landed on a branch beside him. "Whatever are you doing, little one?" she hooted.

"I'm trying to reach the moon," said Pip. "I want to tell it that it's the prettiest light I've ever seen."

Olive blinked her golden eyes. "The moon is very high, Pip. Even I can't fly that far. But perhaps we can find another way."

So the next day, Pip asked his friends for help. Rosie the rabbit brought a ladder. Benny the badger brought a basket of pinecones to stand on. Tilly the tortoise brought a very long piece of string, though nobody was quite sure why.

That night, they stacked the pinecones, propped up the ladder, and Pip climbed to the very top. He reached and reached. But the moon was still far away.

Pip's ears drooped. "It's no use," he sighed. "I'll never reach it."

Then Tilly slowly lifted her head. "Look down, Pip," she said softly.

Pip looked down. There, in the still water of the pond below, the moon was shining back at him, round and bright and close enough to touch.

Pip scrambled down the ladder and ran to the water's edge. He leaned over and smiled. "Hello, Moon," he said. "You're the prettiest light I've ever seen."

The moon's reflection wobbled and sparkled, as if it were smiling too.

Pip turned to his friends: Olive, Rosie, Benny, and Tilly, all gathered around him in the moonlight. "Thank you," he said. "I couldn't have found it without you."

"That's what friends are for," hooted Olive. And they all sat together by the pond, watching their moon, until one by one, their eyes grew heavy and they drifted off to sleep.

The End